Adam R. Scavette

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Current Positions

Federal Reserve Bank of Philadelphia, Community Development & Regional Outreach
Community Development Economic Advisor, 2024-

Temple University, Department of Economics
Adjunct Lecturer, Master of Public Policy Program, 2026-

Education

Ph.D., **Rutgers University–New Brunswick**, Public Policy, 2024
M.S.E., **University of Pennsylvania**, Systems Engineering, 2018
M.Sc., **University of Edinburgh**, Economics, 2011
B.S., **Villanova University**, Economics, 2010

Previous Positions

West Virginia University, Regional Research Institute
Visiting Researcher, 2024–2025
Federal Reserve Bank of Richmond, Research Department
Regional Economist, 2022–2024
Federal Reserve Bank of Philadelphia, Research Department
Sr. Econ. Analyst, 2019–2021; Econ. Analyst, 2015–2018; Research Assoc., 2011–2015

Research Interests

Urban and regional economics; housing economics; labor economics; public economics

Working Papers

"The Local Economic Impact of Coal Mine Closures" (with David Nason and Heather Stephens), **FRB Philadelphia Working Paper 26-30**, 2026.

"The Post-Fentanyl Urbanization of the Opioid Epidemic" (with Alexander Kucera and Zachary Porreca). Revisions requested at ***Journal of Regional Science***.

"Can Environmental Regulations Protect Resources Without Restricting Housing? Evidence from a Dual-Zone Land Use Policy" (with John Borrmann, Theresa Dunne, and Paul Gottlieb).

Peer-Reviewed Articles

"Do Research Universities Recession Proof Their Regions? Evidence from State Flagship College Towns" (with Robert Calvert Jump), ***Journal of Economic Geography***, 2025.

"A better Sahm rule? Introducing the SOS recession indicator" (with John O'Trakoun), ***Economics Letters***, 2025.

"JUE Insight: The Labor Market Effects of Place-Based Policies: Evidence from England's Neighbourhood Renewal Fund" (with Robert Calvert Jump), ***Journal of Urban Economics,*** 144, 2024. Previous Version: FRB Richmond WP 22-02.

"Aerospace Place-Based Policy: The Impact of Boeing on South Carolina's Aerospace Industry." ***Economic Development Quarterly***, 2024.

"The Economic Impact of a Casino Monopoly: Evidence from Atlantic City," ***Regional Science and Urban Economics***, 103, 2023. Previous Version: FRB Richmond WP 23-07.

"The Impact of New Jersey's Urban Enterprise Zones on Local Employment: A Synthetic Control Approach," ***Economic Development Quarterly***, 37(2), 2023, pp. 127-142.

"Exploiting a Natural Hub: Turning a Stopover into a Destination" (with Leah Goldsberry), ***Transportation Research Record: Journal of the Transportation Research Board***, 2672(23), 2018, pp. 8-14.

Federal Reserve Publications: By Topic

Workforce and Economic Development

"How Is AI Impacting Small Business Performance? Evidence from the Third District" (with Theresa Dunne), *FRB Philadelphia: Community Development Brief*, 2026.

"Eds and Meds: Variability of Anchor Institution Employment Impacts Across U.S. Regions" (with Deborah Diamond and Theresa Dunne), *FRB Philadelphia: Community Development Brief*, 2026.

"Has Generative Artificial Intelligence Adoption Impacted Labor Demand at Third District Firms?" (with Theresa Dunne), *FRB Philadelphia: Community Development Brief*, 2026.

"Do Anchor Institutions Support Regional Economic Resiliency? Evidence from Penn State University" (with Robert Calvert Jump and Deborah Diamond), *FRB Philadelphia: Community Development Brief*, 2025.

"Occupational Exposure to Generative Artificial Intelligence in the Third Federal Reserve District" (with Danielle Jenkins and Lei Ding), *FRB Philadelphia: Community Development Report*, 2025.

"How to Make It in Philadelphia: Policy Takeaways from the Survey of Economic Mobility," *FRB Philadelphia: Community Development Brief*, 2025.

"Boeing South Carolina's Economic Impact: Ten Years After Opening," *FRB Richmond: Regional Matters*, 2024.

"Who is Supplying the Labor for Recent Employment Growth in the Rural Fifth District?" *FRB Richmond: Regional Matters*, 2024.

"The Impact of the Francis Scott Key Bridge Collapse on Fifth District Firms" (with Jason Kosakow) *FRB Richmond: Regional Matters*, 2024.

"Parsing the Slow Post-Pandemic Labor Market Recovery of Maryland's Capital Suburbs" (with Keith Waters), *FRB Richmond: Regional Matters*, 2023.

"The Rural Reach of ARPA's Development Grants in the Fifth District" (with Andy Bauer), *FRB Richmond: Regional Matters*, 2023.

"Casinos and Regional Economies: Has the Game Changed?" *FRB Richmond: Economic Brief*, No. 22-28, July 2022.

"How the CHIPS and Science Act Will Target Economic Development in Distressed Labor Markets," *FRB Richmond: Regional Matters*, 2022.

"The Role of Manufacturing in the Rural Fifth District," *FRB Richmond: Regional Matters*, 2022.

"Is Urban Cool Cooling New Jersey's Job Market?" (with Ethan Haswell), *FRB Philadelphia: Research Brief*, December 2016.

Housing, Demographics, and Social Policy

"What Has Driven Recent Multifamily Rent Growth in Major Fifth District Metros? (with Sierra Stoney), *FRB Richmond: Macro Minute*, 2024.

"Understanding Immigration in the Fifth District: Where Did International Migrants Settle?" (with Surekha Carpenter), *FRB Richmond: Regional Matters*, 2024.

"Urban Marylanders Are Migrating to More Affordable and Smaller Metro Areas" (with Keith Waters) *FRB Richmond: Regional Matters*, 2024.

"Unlocking Housing Supply: What Can We Learn About Recent Construction and Permitting Patterns in Our Region?" (with Sierra Stoney), *FRB Richmond: Regional Matters*, 2024.

"Understanding SNAP's Role" (with Carrie Cook, Stephanie Norris, and Alvaro Sanchez), *FRB Richmond: Econ Focus*, 2024: Q1.

"Addressing Baltimore's Abandoned Housing" (with Peter Dolkart), *FRB Richmond: Regional Matters*, 2023.

"Social Capital Across the Fifth District" (with Stephanie Norris), *FRB Richmond: Econ Focus*, 2023: Q3.

"Regional Spotlight: Making Ends Meet," *FRB Philadelphia: Economic Insights*, 2022: Q2.

"Exploring the Economic Effects of the Opioid Epidemic," *FRB Philadelphia: Economic Insights*, 2019: Q2.

"Regional Spotlight: Purchasing Power Across the U.S." (with Elif Sen), *FRB Philadelphia: Economic Insights*, 2017: Q4.

Broadband

"Digital Access Deficiencies in Rural Health Care Deserts: Identifying a Role for Telehealth" (with Alvaro Sánchez), *FRB Richmond: Regional Matters*, 2024.

"The Telehealth Divide: Digital Inequity in Rural Health Care Deserts" (with Alvaro Sánchez, Pearse Haley and Sofia Tenorio Martinez), *FRB Atlanta: Partners Update*, 2024.

"How to Bridge the Digital Divide? Assessing the Affordable Connectivity Program," *FRB Richmond: Regional Matters*, 2022.

"The End of the Digital Divide? The Future of Broadband Post-Infrastructure Investment and Jobs Act (IIJA)", *FRB Richmond: Regional Matters*, 2022.

"Broadband Subscription, Computer Use, and Labor Market Attachment across U.S. Metros" (with Alvaro Sanchez), *FRB Philadelphia: Community Development Report*, June 2021.

The Business Cycle and Inflation

"SOS! Signaling Recessions Earlier" (with John O'Trakoun), *FRB Richmond: Economic Brief*, February 2025.

"Are College Towns Recession Proof? (with Robert Calvert Jump), *FRB Richmond: Regional Matters*, 2024.

"Do Regional Fed Surveys Reflect National Manufacturing Conditions? (with Jason Kosakow), *FRB Richmond: Regional Matters*, 2024.

"Are Fifth District Firms Revisiting Their Prices Less Often Amid Cooling Inflation? (with Jason Kosakow), *FRB Richmond: Regional Matters*, 2024.

"Fifth District State Business Cycles," *FRB Richmond: Regional Matters*, 2023.

"Firm Price-Setting Behavior Amid Elevated Price Growth: Evidence From Our Surveys" (with Jason Kosakow), *FRB Richmond: Regional Matters*, 2023.

"Regional Spotlight: Evaluating Metro Unemployment Rates Throughout the Business Cycle," *FRB Philadelphia*: *Economic Insights*, 2019: Q4.

"Are We in a Recession? The 'Anxious Index Nowcast' Knows*!" FRB Philadelphia: Research Rap Special Report*, 2014.

Media Mentions

New York Times (x2) [**link**; **link**], *Wall Street Journal* **[link]**, *Bloomberg* [**link**], NBC News **[link],** Business Insider **[link]**, *Chicago Sun-Times* (x2) [**link**; **link**], *MarketWatch* [**link**], NPR, *Marketplace*, *Post and Courier* **[link]**, Torsten Slok Newsletter, Congressional Research Service (x2) [**link; link**], *Inside U.S. Trade* [**link**], *National Affairs*, *American Enterprise Institute* [**link**], *Baltimore Banner* (x4) [**link**], *Baltimore Business Journal, City Observatory* [**link**], Indiana Public Media [**link**], *Travel Weekly* [**link**]

Awards

Susan Fainstein Distinguished Doctoral Dissertation Award, Rutgers University, 2024
Runner-up, Tiebout Prize for Best PhD Paper, Western Regional Science Association, 2024
Winner, Moriarty Prize for Best PhD Paper, Southern Regional Science Association, 2023
Runner-up, Tiebout Prize for Best PhD Paper, Western Regional Science Association, 2022
Augustinian Scholarship, Full-tuition merit scholarship, Villanova University, 2006-2010

Academic Presentations

2026: ASSA Annual Meeting, Federal Reserve Bank of St. Louis, Federal Reserve System Economic Heterogeneity Conference+, Society of Government Economists Annual Conference, Consumer Finance Round Robin, Federal Reserve System Community Development Research Conference+, Urban Economics Association (UEA) – North American Meeting+

2025: Federal Reserve Bank of Minneapolis Opportunity & Inclusive Growth Institute Research Conference, Miami University Finance and Real Estate Conference+, Society of Government Economists Annual Meeting, West Virginia University, Federal Reserve Bank of Philadelphia, Federal Reserve System Committee on Regional Analysis Conference+

2024: Federal Reserve Bank of St. Louis, The Urban Institute, WHY Symposium on Policy Evaluation and Causal Inference, Johns Hopkins University, West Virginia University, National Conference of State Legislatures Roundtable on Evaluating Economic Development Tax Incentives, Federal Reserve System Committee on Regional Analysis Conference, Consumer Financial Protection Bureau, Society for Economic Measurement Conference, College of Charleston, Southern Regional Science Association, Western Regional Science Association

2023: Federal Reserve System Committee on Regional Analysis Conference, WHY Symposium on Policy Evaluation and Causal Inference, Southern Regional Science Association, Federal Reserve Bank of Richmond

2022: Federal Reserve Bank of Atlanta, WHY Symposium on Policy Evaluation and Causal Inference, APPAM Fall Research Conference, Society of Government Economists Annual Meeting, Rutgers University Krueckeberg Doctoral Conference, Western Regional Science Association Annual Meeting

2021: Urban Economics Association (UEA) – North American Meeting, Federal Reserve System Committee on Regional Analysis Conference, Rutgers University

2018-2019: Transportation Research Board Annual Meeting, Federal Reserve System Committee on Regional Analysis Conference

+Discussion Only

Op-Eds and Commentary

"Port of Baltimore well positioned to bounce back from Key Bridge loss," *Baltimore Banner*, April 12, 2024.

"The Revival of Urban Enterprise Zones in New Jersey," *New Jersey State Policy Lab*, May 27, 2022.

Professional Service

Referee Reports

American Economic Journal: Macroeconomics, Journal of Public Economics, Regional Science and Urban Economics (x8)*, Economics Letters, Journal of Policy Analysis and Management, Nature Communications, Journal of Regional Science, Contemporary Economic Policy, Economic Development Quarterly, Economic Modelling, Journal of Business Cycle Research, Papers in Regional Science, Telecommunications Policy*

Conference Organization

2026: Chair, Federal Reserve System Committee on Regional Analysis Conference, Dallas, TX.

2025: Chair, Federal Reserve System Committee on Regional Analysis Conference, Washington, DC.

Podcasts

"A New Way of Detecting Recessions" (with John O'Trakoun), *Speaking of the Economy*, April 2025.

"The Role of Anchor Institutions in Regional Economies" (with Deborah Diamond), *Speaking of the Economy*, June 2024.

"The Economic Impact of the Key Bridge Collapse" (with Jason Kosakow), *Speaking of the Economy*, June 2024.

"Figuring Out Maryland's Out-Migration" (with Keith Waters), *Speaking of the Economy*, April 2024.

Teaching

Instructor

Economic Decisions and Public Policy (ECON 5102), Temple University, Fall 2026
Principles of Microeconomics (50:220:102), Rutgers University-Camden, Spring 2026

Teaching Assistant

Research Methods in Policy (10:775:395), Rutgers University-New Brunswick, Fall 2021
Applied Multivariate Methods (833:525:01), Rutgers University-New Brunswick, Fall 2020
Engineering Statistics (ESE 302), University of Pennsylvania, Fall 2016–Spring 2018
Intermediate Microeconomics (ECO 2102), Villanova University, Spring 2010